



College of Science & Mathematics

Spring Semester 2026

BIOL 4350K: Comparative Vertebrate Anatomy

Syllabus

Instructor Information:

Nicholas Green

Email: ngreen62@kennesaw.edu

Office Location: SC 331

Office Phone: 4705786546

Office Hours

By appointment

Preferred Method of Communication: Email or Teams. Do NOT send messages using the D2L messaging system; I will not respond to D2L messages.

Course Information:

Total Credit Hours: 4

Laboratory / Experiential Field Hours: 0

Prerequisites: (BIOL 1108 and BIOL 1108L) and (CHEM 1211 and CHEM 1211L)

Concurrent Prerequisites: None

Co-requisites: None

Course Description:

Students will explore a survey of representative vertebrates and related chordates emphasizing phylogeny and anatomical adaptations. Students will investigate evolutionary trends in the context of large-scale environmental changes that have occurred over geologic time. Using a comparative, systems-based approach, students will explore the relationships between structure and function. In the lab, students will learn to dissect selected vertebrate organisms and study anatomical adaptations among these representative models to recognize the relationships between form and function.

Course Meeting Information:

Lecture: Monday, Wednesday, Friday 2:30 - 3:20 pm, Academic Learning Center (ALC) 2102. In person.

Lab 1: Monday 9:05 - 11:50 am, Science (SC) 247. In person.

Lab 2: Wednesday 9:05 - 11:50 am, Science (SC) 247. In person.

Course Materials:

Vertebrates: Comparative Anatomy, Function, Evolution

Authors: Kenneth V. Kardong

Edition: Any
Recommended

Textbook Costs

- There are no textbooks required for this course.

Course Learning Outcomes:

1. Use knowledge of anatomy to recognize and diagnose various taxa of chordates.
2. Develop an understanding of “the vertebrate story” and the relationships among chordates.

3. Recognize patterns in vertebrate evolution, including convergent evolution, adaptations to meet physical challenges, and historical constraints on vertebrate morphology.
4. Describe how morphological variation facilitates adaptation to a diverse array of lifestyles
5. Dissect, recognize, and identify anatomical structures of major vertebrate organ systems.
6. Interpret comparative morphological data to make inferences about the evolution of vertebrate anatomy.

Course Requirements and Assignments:

Pre-assessment: This is an ungraded quiz designed to assess student knowledge and skills at the beginning of the semester. Students must complete the pre-assessment in order to be eligible for a course grade other than F. If you register late (after the first week), then this requirement is waived. I use the pre-assessment to measure student learning over the course of the semester.

Lecture exams (including the Final Exam) are designed to evaluate your knowledge and understanding of course material. Some questions will test simple recall while others will require synthesis and application of information. Lecture exams consist of a mix of multiple choice, matching, true-false, and short answer/essay questions.

Lab practical exams test your ability to put theory into practice through identification of organisms, anatomical structures, and interpretation of experimental comparative anatomy data.

Course project: Working with your lab team, you will conduct a literature and lab-based investigation into a topic in comparative anatomy that interests you. Students will identify a question, formulate a hypothesis, gather data and test the hypothesis, and present their findings in conference-style poster. A detailed assignment guide will be provided early in the semester.

Laboratory assignments in this course are graded primarily on **completion and participation**, not on whether your results are “correct.” Many lab activities are really opportunities to practice important scientific skills: careful data

collection, collaboration, troubleshooting, and scientific reasoning. So, credit is given for engaging fully in the process rather than for reaching a particular outcome. Some in-lab tasks cannot be completed outside of scheduled lab time and must be submitted before leaving. These activities directly support later exam questions and course objectives, and completing them is necessary to be successful in the course.

Graduate component: The graduate component of the course is an additional assignment or grading item for students enrolled in the graduate version of the course (BIOL 6350). This is designed to make the graduate version of the course more rigorous than the undergraduate version (BIOL 4350K), and to allow the student an opportunity to demonstrate mastery of comparative anatomy in a way that is relevant to their career goals. The nature of the assignment is flexible but must be mutually agreed upon by the student and the instructor. Examples of suitable assignments include:

- Dissection of an additional vertebrate specimen, documented with labeled photos and descriptive text, and presented to the class during a lab section.
- A written research paper (8-12 pages) reviewing the literature on a topic in comparative anatomy that interests the student.
- Designing, writing, and trial-running a short (≈30 minute) active learning activity suitable for inclusion in a future iteration of the undergraduate version of the course (BIOL 4350K).
- Other activities related to comparative vertebrate anatomy, agreed upon by the student and instructor, accounting for approximately 16 additional hours of work over the course of the semester.

Teaching Methods:

This course will use the following teaching methods:

- Collaborative Assignments and Projects
- Undergraduate Research

Evaluation and Grading Information:

General

Assessment in this course is designed to measure different kinds of learning using different methods. Lecture exams and lab practical exams are intended to measure conceptual and procedural mastery, and students complete a structured self-assessment after each exam to evaluate how well they met the course objectives. This process emphasizes self-reflection and calibration, which are very important professional skills in science, while instructor grading is used as a reference point to maintain fairness and consistency. Other components of the course, including laboratory work, the final exam, and the course project, are graded by the instructor using conventional criteria. This blended approach is meant to reduce unnecessary stress, promote honest evaluation of learning, and keep grading focused on growth and understanding rather than purely on point accumulation.

I use a system called [ungrading](#) to assign course grades. It's very different from the grading system you are used to, but the main idea is that your course grade is determined collaboratively by you and the instructor. This policy has several objectives:

- To reduce the anxiety and gamesmanship associated with grading. This frees up time and energy for more useful activities...like learning course material!
- To offer you a chance and incentive to practice self-guided learning and self-assessment of learning. This is a critical professional skill in science and many other fields.
- To make the dynamics of the relationship between instructor and students less adversarial and more collaborative.

Throughout the semester, and at the end of the semester, you will be asked to honestly evaluate your progress in the course and your achievement of the learning objectives. These evaluations will inform the justification for the grade you earn at the end of the semester.

- A rubric will be provided for each self-assessment. You must complete these rubrics and turn them in on time. If you do not turn a rubric, I will

assign a grade based on your exams and assignments in the traditional manner (see 6.2).

- I reserve the right to adjust student grades if the difference between your self-assessed grade and my assessment of your grade is $\geq 7\%$ (about 1 SD of the historical grade distribution).

Grades and assignments

- All exams, including lab exams, are cumulative. Later exams will emphasize more recent material but all course material up to that point is considered fair game for an exam.
- Lab exams will emphasize material covered in lab; but, may include material from lecture that was not explicitly covered in lab.
- Exams and other assignments will be marked and returned within 7 calendar days of the due date.

Course grade composition broken down by exams, lab assignments, and other components.

Item	% of grade		Day	Date	Time
	Undergraduate	Graduate			
Pre-assessment	0%	0%	Su	January 18	11:59 pm Eastern
Lecture exam 1	5%	5%	F	February 13	Lecture period
Lecture exam 2	7.5%	5%	F	March 20	Lecture period
Lecture exam 3	7.5%	5%	F	April 17	Lecture period
Lab exam 1	5%	5%	M/W	February 9 or 11	Lab period
Lab exam 2	7.5%	5%	M/W	March 23 or 25	Lab period
Lab exam 3	7.5%	5%	M/W	April 27 or 29	Lab period
Course project	20%	20%	M	May 4	Lab or lecture period
Lab assignments	20%	10%		Various	Various
Graduate comp.		20%	tbd	tbd	tbd
Final exam	20%	20%	W	May 6	1:00 - 3:00 pm Eastern
Total	100%	100%			

Letter grade percentages and point ranges

- Final letter grades are assigned based on our assessment (yours and mine) of how well you met the course learning objectives (see above).
- Part of the final exam will be a rubric for assessing your overall performance in the course (because there won't be time for the usual post-exam back-and-forth of self-assessment).
- Letter grades are assigned on the traditional 10 percentage point scale: 90-100% = A, 80-90% = B, etc. Per KSU policy there are no +/- grades. Decimal percentages will be rounded up to the nearest integer.

Midterm Grades

A midterm grade may be assigned by the midterm grade due date identified on the academic calendar. This midterm grade is for assessing mid-semester performance at least one week prior to the last day to withdraw without academic penalty. You may view your midterm grade in Owl Express. Note that only your final grade will be officially recorded on your academic transcript.

Course Calendar:

Numbers in parentheses indicate chapters in Kardong textbook. Some lab sections are labeled as "dissection" or "data". "Dissection" means we will be dissecting that day. "Data" means that we will be analyzing comparative morphology data, so you may want to bring a laptop with RStudio installed. If you need a laptop, tell Dr. Green at least 2 business days before class so he can get you a loaner.

Week-by-week schedule of course topics and activities.

Week	Dates	Lecture topic(s)	Lab topic
1	Jan 12, 14, 16	Introduction to CVA (1); Vertebrate story (2,3)	Lab 1: Phylogeny and Diversity
2	Jan 19, 21, 23	Monday: No class (MLK holiday) Vertebrate story (2,3)	No lab (holiday)
3	Jan 26, 28, 30	Vertebrate design (4)	Lab 2: Design (data)
4	Feb 2, 4, 6	Integument (6)	Lab 3: Integument
5	Feb 9, 11, 13	MW: Life history (5) F: Lecture exam 1	Lab exam 1

Week	Dates	Lecture topic(s)	Lab topic
6	Feb 16, 18, 20	Cranial skeleton (7)	Lab 4: Cranial skeleton
7	Feb 23, 25, 27	Postcranial skeleton (8,9)	Lab 5: Postcranial skeleton
8	Mar 2, 4, 6	Muscles (10)	Lab 6: Dissection methods (dissection)
9	Mar 9, 11, 13	No class - Spring Break	No class - Spring Break
10	Mar 16, 18, 20	MW: Muscles F: Lecture exam 2	Lab 7: Muscles (dissection)
11	Mar 23, 25, 27	No lecture	No lab
12	Mar 30, Apr 1, 3	Digestion (13)	Lab exam 2 (hour 1) Lab 8: Internal anatomy 1 (dissection) (hours 2-3)
13	Apr 6, 8, 10	Urogenital Respiration (11)	Lab 9: Internal anatomy 2 (data)
14	Apr 13, 15, 17	MW: Circulation (12) F: Lecture exam 3	Lab 10: Circulation (dissection)
15	Apr 20, 22, 24	Nervous and Sensory (16, 17)	Lab 11: Nervous and sensory (dissection)
16	Apr 27, 29, May 1	Conclusions (18)	Lab exam 3
17	May 4, May 6	M: Poster presentations (section 2) W: Final exam 1-3 pm	Lab section 1: Poster presentations (section 1, section 2 optional). Lab section 2: No meeting
18	Thursday May 14	Final grades due to Registrar @ 12:00 pm	

Course Policies:

Attendance Policy

- Attendance is highly encouraged but not graded. This means that

“excused absences” apply to exams and assignment deadlines rather than routine class meetings.

- Excused absences as referred to in this syllabus include but are not limited to the following reasons: serious illness of self or a close loved one (requiring the student’s absence), death of a close loved one, travel or other commitment related to official KSU business (including another course), interviews for graduate or professional programs, civic responsibilities (e.g., military service, jury duty, etc.), closure of the university, or other serious issues at the discretion of the instructor.
- Appropriate documentation for an excused absence must be provided upon request.
- If you can foresee an absence on an exam date, please contact me as soon as possible ahead of time so we can plan for assignments, exams, or activities you might miss.

Missed exams and assignments

- If you miss a mid-term lecture exam for an excused reason (see above), and you provide me with acceptable written documentation for the absence upon request, then you can either (1) take a make-up exam at most 1 week after the missed exam date; or (2) use the percentage score on the Final Exam to replace the missed exam. You must choose before taking the make-up exam.
- If you miss a lab exam for an excused reason (see above), and you provide me with acceptable written documentation for the absence upon request, then the percentage score on the Final Exam will replace the missed exam. There are no make-up lab exams. If you can foresee missing a lab exam, you can arrange with the instructor to take the lab exam with the other lab section. In this case, you must notify Dr. Green at least 24 h before the missed exam or the make-up exam, whichever is sooner.

General course policies

- Collegial and respectful behavior towards all people is expected at all times. This does not mean you cannot express your opinions; it means you must respect other people as you do so.
- Use of electronic devices is permitted, under the following conditions:
 - Device use does not disrupt other students or the class (silence your phones!)
 - No electronic devices of any kind may be used during lecture or laboratory exams. Doing so will be considered academic dishonesty (i.e., cheating) and incur penalties as such.
 - Recording of class is not permitted without the express written

permission of the instructor.

Lab safety policies

- General laboratory safety guidelines are available here.
- Do not eat or drink anything in the lab—no exceptions!
- Smoking, vaping, or use of any tobacco product is prohibited.
- Wash your hands after leaving the lab—every time!
- You must wear appropriate lab attire at all times in the lab:
 - **Short-sleeve or long-sleeve shirt.** This means no bare midriffs or shoulders. I.e., at least a t-shirt.
 - **Leg coverings that reach your shoes.** Shorts and capri-length pants are not permitted.
 - **Closed-toed shoes.** Sandals, open-toed shoes, and open-heeled shoes are not permitted.
 - Safety glasses and gloves must be worn when handling fluid-preserved specimens (KSU provides these).
- **If you are not dressed appropriately for lab, then you will be required to leave.** This policy applies even on days when we are not dissecting.
- The instructor has the final say in whether or not your clothing is appropriate for lab. There will be no negotiation about the meanings of common English words such as “shoes” or “pants”.
- Know the locations of emergency exits, fire extinguishers, eye wash stations, and the first aid kit.
- Responsible stewardship of shared laboratory equipment and specimens is expected at all times.

Open lab policies

- The teaching lab (SC 247) will be available during off-hours so that you can complete dissections, examine specimens, or study with other students.
- Open lab hours are whenever the Science Building is open: M-F 7:30 AM – 11:00 PM and Saturday 7:30 AM – 5:00 PM, **except** when the lab is occupied by a class. The Science Building is closed on Sunday.
- The lab will be closed at 2:00 PM the **day before each lab practical exam** for exam set up.
- **Open access to the teaching lab is a privilege and good stewardship is expected.** This means that each student is expected to maintain the cleanliness, organization, and security of the lab. Issues with lab condition or theft will result in access privileges being revoked.
- Cases of theft or destruction of university property will be referred to the KSU police department.

Policy on the Usage of Artificial Intelligence:

General

- In this class, you are welcome to use generative “artificial intelligence” (hereafter “AI”) tools for any purpose other than taking exams. Generative AI is here to stay, so it is incumbent on all of us to learn to use it responsibly. Here’s the important thing to remember: AI should be a **supplement** to your knowledge and skills, not a **replacement** for knowledge and skills.
- You should note that all AI generative tools tend to make up incorrect facts and fake citations, code generation models sometimes to produce inaccurate outputs, and image/art generation tools can produce copied work or offensive products. You will be responsible for any inaccurate, biased, offensive, or otherwise unethical content you submit regardless of how it was created.
- If you use an AI tool, you must describe its contribution in your submission. The use of an AI tool without acknowledgement is cheating and constitutes a violation of the KSU Code of Academic Integrity.

Special concerns about AI use in Comparative Anatomy:

- Knowledge in CVA, particularly taxonomic and phylogenetic nomenclature, is frequently updated in the literature and these changes may not be detected or interpreted correctly by the AI. For example, some of the nomenclature presented in this course is based on studies published very recently, which may not be in the corpus ingested by the AI.
- Do NOT ask any AI to provide you with data (i.e., actual numbers) for your course project. If the AI pulls the numbers directly from a paper or book, use and cite that paper or book. Otherwise, there is a high probability that the AI is simply fabricating data.
- Exams (lecture and lab) are designed so that AI cannot help you—even if you could use electronics on exams, which you may not. AI might be very good for summarizing lecture notes, preparing study guides, summarizing papers or videos, generating practice exams, or even writing R code to analyze data for your course project. If you find a use case where AI helped you in this course, please let me know about it!

Modified Operations Policy:

Kennesaw State University is committed to remaining open and continuing full operations, including class schedules, whenever possible. The Office of the President, in consultation with the KSU Office of Emergency Management and other officials, will determine when an emergency impacts KSU's normal operations. When the University is closed due to an emergency, all classes will be canceled, and non-essential personnel will not be expected to work.

When the University shifts to modified operations, Cabinet members, in consultation with the Office of the President or designee and the Office of Emergency Management, will be responsible for determining appropriate operational continuity for their divisions. This may include remote work. During modified operations, each faculty member will be responsible for instructional continuity for their classes. To ensure instructional continuity, all Academic Colleges and Departments are expected to maintain and regularly update instructional continuity plans. All syllabi should also include an instructional continuity plan statement specific to that course.

During a weather event or other emergency, those commuting to campus should exercise their best judgment when determining travel options. If the University remains open and an employee elects not to report to work, the employee will be required to use their accrued vacation time.

The University will announce campus closures and delayed schedules in several ways. The cell phone number on file with the university will automatically receive KSU Alerts, so make sure your information in OwlExpress is accurate at all times. An email will also be sent to your university account.

In addition, announcements will be made by a notice on the Kennesaw State University home page.

Course continuity plan includes:

Communication: Please monitor your email or D2L for necessary

instructions.

Virtual Classes: If in-person classes are not possible, we may transition to virtual classes using MS Teams only for the days and times when campus is closed.

Assignments and Assessments: Deadlines for assignments and assessments will be adjusted to accommodate the emergency situation. Please monitor your email or D2L for necessary instructions. If an emergency forces us to shift an assignment or assessment time, a new syllabus will be posted to D2L.

We understand that emergencies create unique challenges. If you need additional support during an emergency, reach out via e-mail. The university also offers resources such as counseling and academic support, which can be accessed remotely.

Institutional Policies:

Academic Integrity Statement:

Every KSU student is responsible for upholding the provisions of the [Student Code of Conduct](#), as published in the Undergraduate and Graduate Catalogs. Section 5c of the Student Code of Conduct addresses the university's policy on academic honesty, including provisions regarding plagiarism and cheating, unauthorized access to university materials, misrepresentation/falsification of university records or academic work, malicious removal, retention, or destruction of library materials, malicious/intentional misuse of computer facilities and/or services, and misuse of student identification cards. Incidents of alleged academic misconduct will be handled through the established procedures of the Department of Student Conduct and Academic Integrity (SCAI), which includes either an "informal" resolution by a faculty member, resulting in a grade adjustment, or a formal hearing procedure, which may subject a student to the Code of Conduct's minimum one semester suspension requirement.

KSU Disruption of Campus Life policy:

All students are responsible for knowing the information, policies and procedures

outlined in the Kennesaw State University Codes of Conduct. [Student Conduct and Academic Integrity \(SCAI\)](#) includes: the general Student Code of Conduct, the Residential Code of Conduct, and the Code of Academic Integrity.

KSU Web Accessibility:

Federal law Section 508 Subsection 1194.22 of the Rehabilitation Act and the Board of Regents (BOR) of the University System of Georgia (USG) Web Accessibility Guidelines require that all web content meet the federal government's accessibility guidelines. As such, KSU complies with USG guidelines.

University accessibility assistance is provided by several offices as noted below. Staff in these offices work to accommodate requests for access or assistance with access as soon as possible in order to either accommodate the request or identify an effective alternative for the requester.

Request for Office Contact Number Contact Email

- Student Support Services Student Disability Services 470-578-2666 sds@kennesaw.edu
- University Information Technology Services 470-578-6999 service@kennesaw.edu
- Third Party Technology Assistance University Information Technology Services 470-578-6999 service@kennesaw.edu

KSU Reasonable Accommodations:

Students with qualifying disabilities under the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) and/or Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act who require “reasonable accommodation(s)” to complete the course may request those from Office of Student Disability Services. Students requiring such accommodations are required to work with the University’s Office of Student Disability Services rather than engaging in this discussion with individual faculty members or academic departments. If, after reviewing the course syllabus, a student anticipates or should have anticipated a need for accommodation, he or she must submit documentation requesting an accommodation and permitting time for a determination prior to submitting assignments or taking course quizzes or exams.

Students may not request retroactive accommodation for needs that were or should have been foreseeable. Students should contact the office as soon as possible in the term for which they are seeking accommodations. Student Disability Services is located in Kennesaw Hall, Room 1205 on the Kennesaw campus and Building A in Suite 160G on the Marietta campus. Please visit the [Student Disability Services \(SDS\) website](#) for more information, or call the office at 470-578-2666 (Kennesaw campus) or 470-578-7361 (Marietta campus).

KSU Enrollment Management/Course Attendance:

Students are solely responsible for managing their enrollment status in a class; nonattendance does not constitute a withdrawal.

Copyright Law:

It is the responsibility of KSU faculty and students to respect the rights of copyright holders and complying with copyright law. The University System of Georgia recognizes that the exclusive rights of copyright holders are balanced by limitations on those rights under federal copyright law, including the right to make a fair use of copyrighted materials and the right to perform or display works in the course of face-to-face teaching activities.

The University System of Georgia facilitates compliance with copyright law and, where appropriate, the exercise in good faith of full fair use rights by faculty and staff in teaching, research, and service activities. The University System of Georgia ensure compliance with copyright law in the following ways.

1. The USG informs and educates students, faculty, and staff about copyright law, including the limited exclusive rights of copyright holders as set forth in 17 U.S.C. § 106, the application of the four fair use factors in 17 U.S.C. § 107, and other copyright exceptions.
2. The USG develops and makes available tools and resources for faculty and staff to assist in determining copyright status and ownership and determining whether use of a work in a specific situation would be a fair use and, therefore, not an infringement under copyright law;
3. The USG facilitates use of materials currently licensed by the University System of Georgia and provides information on licensing of third-party materials by the University System; and
4. The USG identifies individuals at the University System and member institutions who can counsel faculty and staff regarding application of

copyright law.

Protecting Students' Privacy (FERPA):

Students have certain rights to privacy. These rights are mandated by federal policy. [The Student Handbook](#) contains information regarding Rights Pertaining to Student Records, and FERPA specific details are available on the [KSU FERPA website](#).

A key requirement of the formal evaluation process is the protection of individual privacy rights concerning educational grading. The University's online learning system and email system is designed to prevent unauthorized individuals from gaining access to sensitive information or information protected by federal or state law. Consequently, faculty and students are strongly encouraged to only communicate regarding course matters through the University's designated technology learning system.

Information should not be made public in any way in which a student's grades, social security number, or other personal information may be identified. Grade information may be shared with members of the KSU community who also have a legitimate educational interest in student success (e.g. academic advisors or members of the Behavioral Response Team). Faculty may be asked to provide early alert information if there is a concern that a student is at risk, academically or otherwise.

KSU Sexual Misconduct:

In accordance with federal and state law including, Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 ("Title IX") and Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 (Title VII), the University System of Georgia (USG), including Kennesaw State University, prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex in any of its education programs or activities or in employment. The USG is committed to ensuring the highest ethical conduct of the members of its community by promoting a safe learning and working environment. To that end, Kennesaw State University follows USG Board of Regents Policy Manual, Section 6.7. [Visit Title IX](#).

Withdrawal from Classes:

A student who officially withdraws from a course by the end of the last day to

withdraw without academic penalty will receive a grade of “W” and receive no credit.

A student will receive a refund only when the student withdraws from ALL courses for the applicable semester and only by the schedule outlined in the University refund policy found in the Tuition, Expenses, & Financial Aid section of the undergraduate and graduate university catalogs.

Students should be aware that a reduction in their hours might result in the loss of full-time student status and thus affect their financial aid, scholarships, athletic and ticket eligibility, University housing accommodations, use of University resources and access to University facilities, visa for international students, and Veterans Educational Benefits. Students should contact the appropriate office and their academic advisor with questions about the impact of their withdrawal from a course before initiating a withdrawal. Veterans and dependents of veterans who receive educational benefits must notify the Veterans Education Benefits Area in the Office of the Registrar of any course load reductions.

Hardship Withdrawals

If a student experiences significant personal hardship (e.g., medical or family emergency, prolonged illness), the Dean of Students can approve a hardship withdrawal from all courses in the term for which the student is currently registered. In the case of an approved hardship withdrawal from all courses, the Registrar will assign grades of “W” for those classes. The deadline for final approval of a hardship withdrawal by the Dean of Students is the last day of class for which the hardship withdrawal is sought. If the hardship withdrawal process is not complete by the last day of class for which the hardship withdrawal is sought, a student must appeal for a retroactive hardship withdrawal from the Academic Standing Committee.

Appeals for retroactive hardship withdrawals must be directed to the Academic Standing Committee. Retroactive hardship withdrawals are rarely granted if it has been more than one year since the last day of class for which the withdrawal is sought. Extraordinary justification must be shown. In the case of approved retroactive hardship withdrawals, the Registrar will assign a grade of

“W.”

University Initiated Withdrawals

If a student is suspended by the Office of Student Conduct following a violation of the University’s Code of Conduct not related to academic dishonesty, the Office of Student Conduct may facilitate a University-initiated withdrawal from courses for which a student is registered for the term. The Registrar will assign grades of “W” for those classes.

Military Withdrawals

A student will receive a “WM” symbol for all courses and a full refund of tuition and mandatory fees and a pro rata refund of other fees for military and other service, as defined by [BOR Policy Manual, Section 7.3.5.3](#). To request a military withdrawal, the student must submit a copy of official orders to the Office of the Registrar.

Academic Feedback:

Institutional Chief Academic Officers will encourage faculty to clarify for students, at the beginning of each course, the basis on which grades will be determined and to provide timely academic feedback as the course progresses ([BOR Academic and Student Handbook Policy 2.18](#))

Netiquette: Communication Courtesy:

All members of the class are expected to follow rules of common courtesy in all email messages, threaded discussions and chats. See [Email Best Practices](#) for additional guidance.

Course Delivery:

KSU may shift the method of course delivery at any time during the semester in compliance with University System of Georgia health and safety guidelines. In this case, alternate teaching modalities that may be adopted include hyflex, hybrid, synchronous online, or asynchronous online instruction. Please refer to the Instructional Continuity statement included in each course syllabus for specific plans.

University Sponsored Academic Resources:

University Academic Resources:

- [Academic Tutoring Services](#)
- [Disability Resources](#)
- [Library](#)
- [Supplemental Instruction](#)
- [The Writing Center](#)
- [Virtual Smart Center](#)
- [Academic Advising](#)

Student Resources:

- [Student Support Links for Online Learning](#)
- [Student Success Resources](#)
- [Scholarships and Financial Aid](#)
- [Office of the Registrar](#)
- [Office of the Bursar](#)

Grade Appeals and Student Complaints:

KSU desires to resolve student grievances, complaints and concerns in an expeditious, fair and amicable manner. The [complaints and concerns webpage](#) was developed to assist current and prospective students in submitting complaints and appeals, and to direct them to the most effective venue for accurate information and resolution. The resources on the page will direct students to the specific venue to appropriately address the related student complaint.

Complaints for online students are resolved following the same general procedures for students who attend classes on campus. However, for any process that requires a student appear in person, the university may make other arrangements. For processes that cannot be completed via telephone, email, or written correspondence, the university may set up a two-way video-conference site in place of a meeting on the KSU campus.

Technology Resources:

For issues with technical difficulties, please contact the Student Helpdesk:

[Fill out a service form](#)

Email: studenthelpdesk@kennesaw.edu

Call 470-578-3555

[New Students Technology Services](#)- Steps that will help you meet the technological requirements of the University.

Any request for make-ups due to technical issues MUST be accompanied by the ticket number received from UITs when the problem was reported to them. The ticket number will document the time and date of the problem. You MUST e-mail your instructor within 24 hours of the technical difficulty if you wish to request a make-up.

Additional Technology Resources:

- [Computer Labs](#)
- [Browser Checker](#)
- [My KSU Site for Accessing Online Tools](#)
- [USG Desire2Learn Help Center](#)
- [D2L Training Options & Resources for Students](#)
- [Owltrain Online Courses](#)
- [Check Service Outages](#)

Student Support and Wellness Resources:

YOU MATTER at KSU, and your well-being is a priority to us. College is exciting, but it can cause students to experience stress and feel overwhelmed. Through counseling, health education, addiction and recovery support, fitness and recreation activities, and access to basic needs, Wellbeing@KSU is here to help you do well and be well.

- [Department of Career Planning & Development](#)
- [Student Health Clinic](#)

- [Military and Veteran Services](#)

Faculty Profile (USG CV Requirement)

Directory Information:

Directory Information:

Name: Nicholas Green

Title: Associate Professor of Biology

Department: Department of Ecology, Evolution, and Organismal Biology

Mail drop: 1202

Degrees Earned:

Degrees Earned with Institutions:

B.S. in Biology, concentration in Ecology and Evolution, University of Louisville

Ph.D. in Biology, Baylor University

Teaching Interests:

My teaching is concentrated in two areas: vertebrate biology, and biological data analysis. One of my primary goals for all of my courses is to improve the quantitative and statistical reasoning skills of students. This often means introducing students to state-of-the-art methods in data collection and analysis, often far beyond what most biology majors might otherwise encounter in their undergraduate careers.

Research Interests:

The [Green Quantitative Ecology Lab \(QuantEco\)](#) uses advanced mathematical and statistical tools to investigate relationships between living organisms and their environment. Most of our research focuses on understanding how human activities, like urbanization and climate change, affect fish and wildlife across all levels of biological organization.

While our research is often at the cutting-edge of quantitative methods, we are grounded in a rigorous tradition of field ecology and mammalogy. Our work takes us all over Georgia, from the northern Ridge and Valley to the barrier islands of the coast. To complement our computational and field work, we use a wide variety of lab methods like DNA extraction, ELISA, necropsy, craniometry, and microscopy gather the data we need from the samples we collect.

Some of our current projects are listed below and described in more detail on our [lab website](#). If you are interested in participating, please email Dr. Green (ngreen62@kennesaw.edu).

- Spatial ecology of small mammals in urbanizing environments
- Effects of climate change and urbanization on the Etowah watershed
- Osmoregulation in American Alligators
- Effects of climate change on marine food webs

Recent Scholarship:

Where to find lab research

[Lab website](#)

[Google Scholar profile](#)

[ORCID profile](#)

Publications since joining KSU

Wildhaber ML, Albers JL, Green NS. 2025. Understanding predator-prey-

competitor dynamics between Lower Missouri River *Macrhybopsis* and *Scaphirhynchus* using a combined population—bioenergetics model. *Ecological Modelling* 504: 111097. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecolmodel.2025.111097>.

Anderson C, Weand M, Alexander H, Bretfeld M, Green NS. 2025. Variations in stand structure, composition, and fuelbeds drive prescribed fire behavior during mountain longleaf pine restoration. *Forest Ecology and Management* 575: 122372. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foreco.2024.122372>;

Hooper MJ, Struckhoff MA, Isanhart JP, Albers JL, Grabner KW, Green NS, Kunz BK, McDonald MV, West BM. 2024. Studies to assess natural resource recovery and evaluate monitoring methods for restored bottomland hardwood forests. *Integrated Environmental Assessment and Management*. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1002/ieam.4996>;

West BM, Wildhaber ML, Green NS, Isanhart JP, McDonald MV, Hooper MJ. 2024. Survey effort and targeted landbird community metrics at Indiana lowland forest restoration sites. *Integrated Environmental Assessment and Management*. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1002/ieam.4992>.

Wildhaber ML, West BM, Bennett KR, May JH, Albers JL, Green NS. 2024. Sicklefin Chub (*Macrhybopsis meeki*) and Sturgeon Chub (*M. gelida*) temporal and spatial patterns from extant population monitoring and habitat data spanning 23 years. *Fishes* 9: 43. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.3390/fishes9020043>.

Albers J, Wildhaber M, Green N, Struckhoff M, Hooper M. 2023. Visitor use and activities detected using trail cameras at forest restoration sites. *Ecological Restoration* 41: 199-212. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.3368/er.41.4.199>.

Green NS, Wildhaber ML, Albers JL. 2022. Interaction between transect design and animal distribution in distance sampling of deer. *Wildlife Society Bulletin* 46: e1368. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1002/wsb.1368>.

Green NS, Li S, Maul JD, Overmyer J. 2022. Natural and anthropogenic factors and their interactions drive stream community integrity in a North American river basin at a large spatial scale. *Science of the Total Environment* 835, 155344.

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2022.155344>.

Preston TM, Wildhaber ML, Green NS, Albers JL, Debenedetto GP. 2021. Enumerating white-tailed deer using unmanned aerial vehicles. Wildlife Society Bulletin 45: 97-108. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1002/wsb.1149>

Green NS, Wildhaber ML, Albers JL. 2021. Effectiveness of a distance sampling from roads program for white-tailed deer in the National Capital Region Parks. Natural Resource Report NPS/NCR/NRR—2021/2224. U.S. National Park Service, Fort Collins, Colorado. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.36967/nrr-2284469>.

Green NS, Wildhaber ML, Albers JL, Pettit TW, Hooper MH. 2020. Efficient mammal biodiversity surveys for ecological restoration monitoring. Integrated Environmental Assessment and Management. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1002/ieam.4324>.